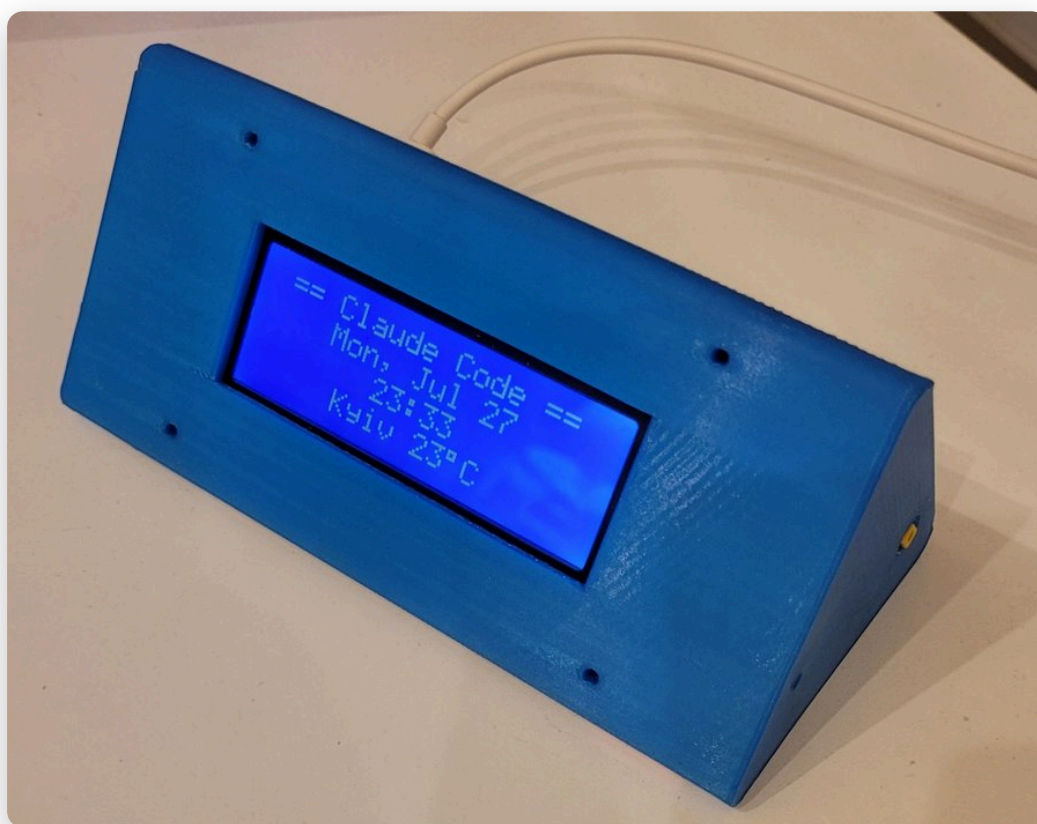


# CLAUDIUS I

Hardware status indicator for Claude Code  
User Guide



Plainstack technologies · Chaos into systems.  
2026

# 1. What Claudius I is

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Claudius I is a desktop device that shows, in real time, what Claude Code is doing on your computer. One glance at the screen tells you whether Claude is free, working, has asked a question, or is waiting for a permission. The device also shows your plan-usage limit, a clock with local weather, and — for cities in Ukraine — air-raid alerts with an audible siren.

The screen is a classic 20×4 character LCD (HD44780). Every screen mock-up in this guide is drawn with the very same 5×8-dot character generator the physical display itself uses.

## 2. What's in the box, and requirements

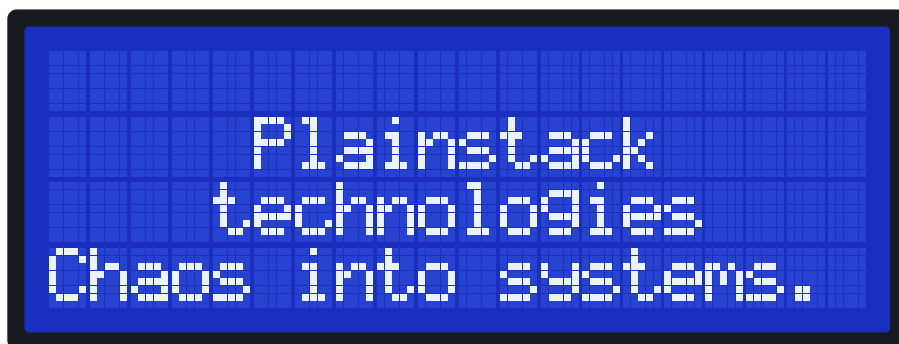
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- the Claudius I device;
- a USB-C cable that carries data (not power-only);
- a USB drive with the installer and this guide.

What your computer needs:

- Windows 10/11, Linux, or macOS 11+;
- Claude Code installed and logged in ( <https://claude.com/claude-code> — run it at least once and sign in *before* setting up the device).

Plug the device into your computer with the USB-C cable — the screen lights up, shows a boot splash, then the clock. No separate power adapter is needed; any USB port works, the device is found automatically.



Boot splash screen

## 3. Installing the software

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### 3.1. Windows — 5 minutes

1. Plug in the device with the USB-C cable and insert the USB drive.
2. Open the `ClaudeStatus` folder on the drive.
3. Right-click `setup.ps1` → *Run with PowerShell*. If that's blocked by policy, open PowerShell in this folder and run two lines instead:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass  
.\setup.ps1
```

4. A setup wizard opens in your browser. Its first page just waits for the device — plug it in via USB-C now if you haven't already; the page finds it on its own, installs Python 3 if it's missing, replaces an

incompatible USB driver if needed (this may show **one** administrator confirmation — accept it), and flashes the latest firmware, with nothing for you to click.

5. The wizard then asks you to pick your city on the map (for weather and alerts) and set brightness and sound preferences — brightness changes show live on the device itself as you drag the slider.
6. When the wizard shows *All set!*, the device shows the same message. Open any terminal and run `claude` — the screen starts updating on the first response. (If Claude isn't started within a couple of minutes, the device falls back to the clock on its own — see 4.1.)

### 3.2. Linux / macOS — 5 minutes

1. Plug in the device. No driver is needed: Linux has one built into the kernel, macOS 11+ ships one with the OS.
2. Copy the `ClaudeStatus` folder from the drive to your computer, open a terminal in it, and run: `bash setup.sh`
3. The script installs python3, pyserial and avrdude through your package manager (it may ask for your sudo password), flashes the device, and asks the same questions in the terminal: city, brightness, sounds.
4. On Linux you'll be added to the `dialout` group — that becomes permanent after you log out and back in, but the installer also grants temporary access right away, so everything works without a re-login.
5. Run `claude` in a terminal.

### 3.3. Changing settings, and uninstalling

- To change city, brightness, or sounds — just run the installer again; the device will remember the new settings.
- Brightness can also be changed without the wizard: `python b1.py 50` (0–100) from the app folder.
- Full removal: `uninstall.ps1` (Windows) or `bash uninstall.sh` (Linux/macOS) from the `ClaudeStatus` folder.

### 3.4. Installer options (optional)

The installer can be run with flags — useful if something wasn't detected automatically, or if you want to skip the interactive wizard:

| Windows<br>( <code>setup.ps1</code> ) | Linux / macOS ( <code>setup.sh</code> ) | Effect                                                 |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>-Port COM7</code>               | <code>--port /dev/ttyUSB0</code>        | set the device port manually instead of auto-detecting |
| <code>-City "Berlin"</code>           | — (city is asked in the terminal)       | set the city without the interactive wizard            |
| <code>-NoWeather</code>               | <code>--no-weather</code>               | disable weather and air-raid alerts entirely           |
| <code>-NoAutostart</code>             | <code>--no-autostart</code>             | don't add a background auto-start entry at login       |

Example: `.\setup.ps1 -City "Kyiv" -NoAutostart` or `bash setup.sh --no-weather`.

### 3.5. What gets installed, and where

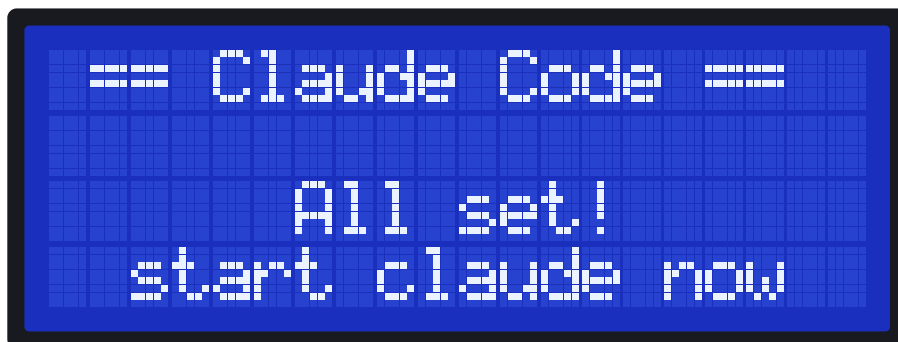
| Component                      | Windows                                                       | Linux / macOS                                         |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| App files                      | %LOCALAPPDATA%\ClaudeStatus\app                               | ~/.local/share/claude-status/app                      |
| Claude Code hooks              | ~/.claude/settings.json (an existing file is backed up first) |                                                       |
| Autostart                      | Task Scheduler entry<br>«ClaudeStatusDaemon»                  | systemd user service (Linux) /<br>LaunchAgent (macOS) |
| Log file                       | %TEMP%\claude_lcd_daemon.log                                  | /tmp/claude_lcd_daemon.log                            |
| Python 3, pyserial,<br>avrdude | installed automatically if missing                            |                                                       |

For the curious: technical details and architecture live in `readme.txt` and `ClaudeStatus/README.md` on the drive. For installation and everyday use, this guide is all you need.

## 4. Screens and states

### 4.1. All set! (setup finished)

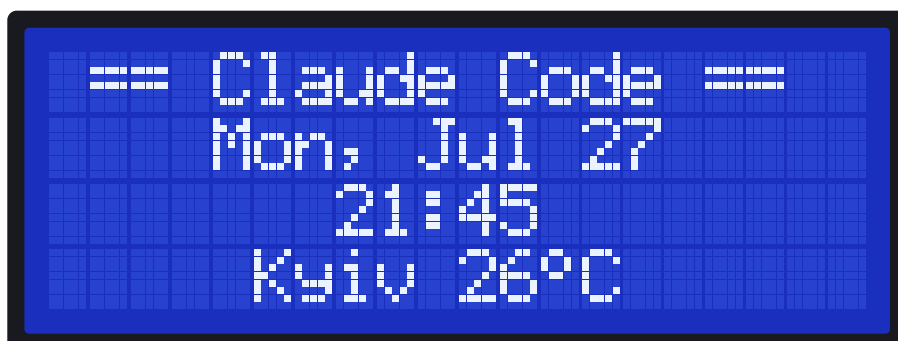
Shown the moment the browser setup wizard finishes — before you've even closed the browser tab. It's a cue to open a terminal and start Claude. If Claude hasn't been started within a couple of minutes, the device gives up waiting and falls back to the clock (4.2) on its own.



Setup just finished

### 4.2. Clock (idle screensaver)

Shown while Claude Code isn't running, and also after 5 minutes of inactivity: time, date, city and temperature (refreshed once a minute). Any activity from Claude immediately restores the working screen.



Clock with date and weather

### 4.3. IDLE — Claude is free

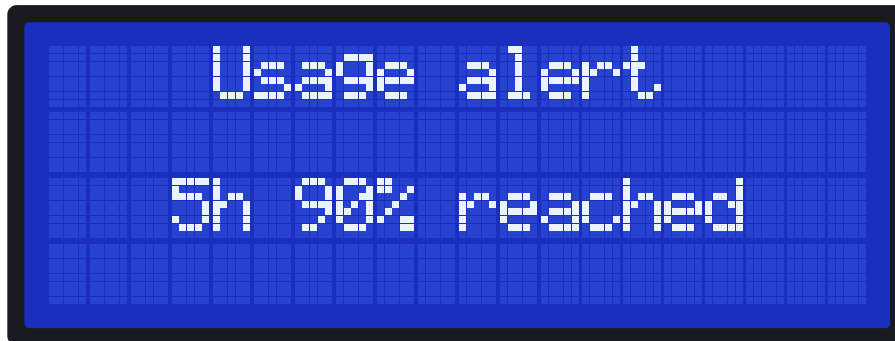
A Claude Code session is open with no task running. The bottom row shows your 5-hour plan-usage percentage and the time until it resets (the same numbers shown on [claude.ai](https://claude.ai) → Usage).



Idle state with the usage line

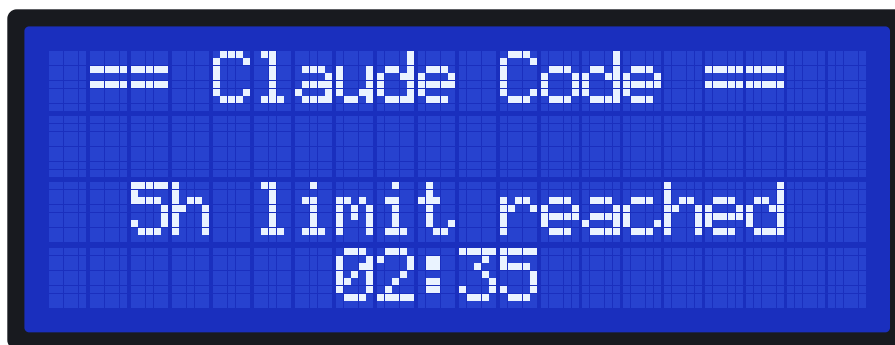
#### 4.4. Approaching and reaching a usage limit

As your 5-hour or weekly usage crosses 75% and 90%, the device briefly shows what changed alongside the warning beep — so a beep heard during the screensaver is never a mystery:



Brief heads-up shown with the 75%/90% beep

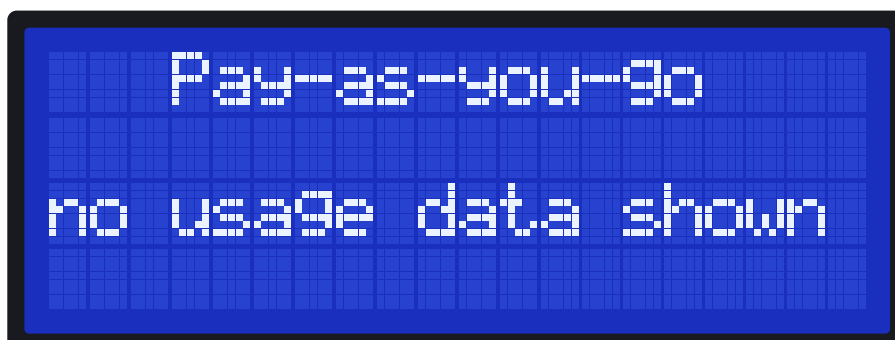
Once a window is completely used up, the screen switches to a dedicated limit screen with a live countdown to when it resets — `HH:MM` for the 5-hour limit, `Xd:HH:MM` for the weekly one:



5-hour limit reached, resets in 2h35m

The moment the window resets, a chime plays and the device returns to IDLE on its own — no action needed.

On a pay-as-you-go plan (an API key instead of a Claude subscription) there's no 5-hour/weekly limit to track. The device shows a one-time notice instead of the usage line, and otherwise behaves exactly the same — WORKING, IDLE, the clock screensaver, WAITING FOR INPUT and PERMISSION? all work normally.



One-time notice on a pay-as-you-go plan

#### 4.5. WORKING — Claude is working

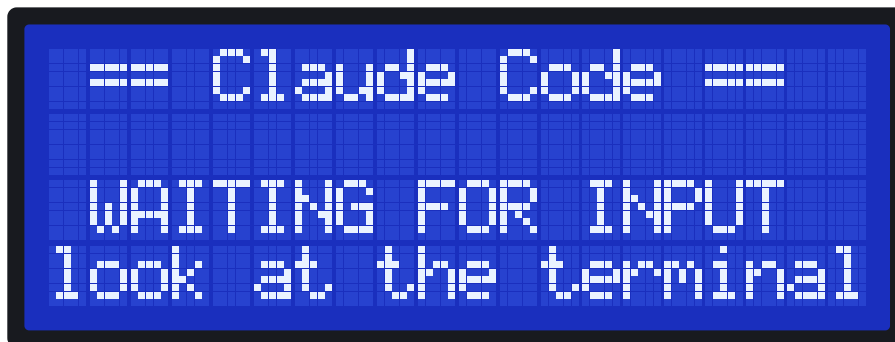
The top row shows the name of the project (folder) Claude is working in. The center shows a "verb" describing the work, matching Claude Code's own animated label (a different one each time). The bottom row is the 5-hour usage bar.



Working on project "my-project", 42% of the limit used

#### 4.6. WAITING FOR INPUT — Claude is waiting for a reply

Claude has asked a question in the terminal. The device plays a short rising chirp; a message longer than 20 characters scrolls as a marquee, and the backlight switches to full brightness for the duration to draw your attention.



Waiting for the user's reply

#### 4.7. PERMISSION? — a permission request

Claude is asking permission for an action (running a command, editing a file, etc). A distinct sound plays. As soon as you answer in the terminal and Claude continues, the screen returns to WORKING on its own.



Requesting permission to run a command

#### 4.8. OFFLINE — no session

No running Claude Code session was found. Run `claude` in a terminal — the state changes automatically.



Claude Code isn't running

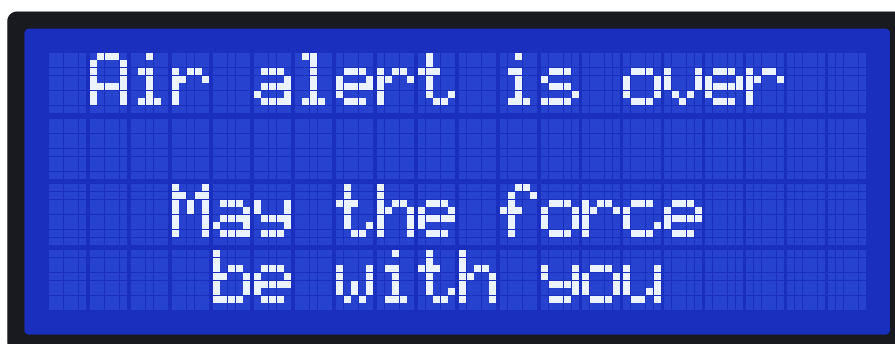
#### 4.9. Air-raid alert (for cities in Ukraine)

If a city in Ukraine is selected in the settings, the device watches for air-raid alerts in your oblast through open public feeds (no accounts or keys needed). A siren plays and a warning screen appears the moment an alert starts.



Air-raid alert screen

Pressing the button dismisses the alert screen (the sound won't repeat), but while the alert is still active, the top row keeps flashing `AIR RAID ALERT` as a reminder. A short melody plays once the all-clear comes:



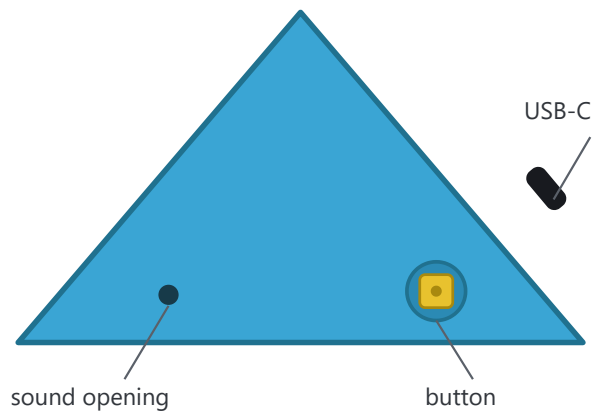
Air-raid all-clear

### 5. The button

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There is a button on the right side face of the enclosure; to its left is a sound opening (don't cover it). The USB-C connector sits near the back edge.





The device's right side face (schematic)

- **Press** — turn the display off or on. When the display is off, all sounds are muted too.
- **During an alert** — a press dismisses the alert screen.
- **If the screen went dark** (e.g. after the computer went to sleep) — a press brings it back.

## 6. Sound signals

| Event                                        | Sound                                                |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Claude finished working                      | falling fifth (A → D)                                |
| Claude is waiting for a reply                | rising fifth (D → A)                                 |
| Permission request                           | a distinct short pattern                             |
| 75% of the limit used (5-hour / 7-day)       | double warning chirp, with a brief on-screen message |
| 90% of the limit used                        | triple cascade, with a brief on-screen message       |
| A usage window resets after being fully used | major arpeggio, then back to IDLE                    |
| Air-raid alert starts                        | siren                                                |
| Alert all-clear                              | major arpeggio                                       |

Sounds can be turned off in the setup wizard (re-run the installer), or temporarily by turning off the display with the button.

## 7. Display automation

- The screen blanks together with your computer's monitors and wakes up with them — on Windows, macOS, and Linux (X11 and GNOME are supported on Linux).
- After 5 minutes in IDLE, the clock screensaver turns on.
- The backlight temporarily switches to full brightness during a marquee-scrolling message (see section 4.6).
- Time and date are synced from your computer automatically on every connection.

## 8. If something isn't working

| Symptom                                         | What to do                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Screen is dark                                  | Check that the USB-C cable carries data (not charge-only); try another port; press the button.                                                                                                |
| States aren't updating                          | Make sure Claude Code is running ( <code>c_l_a_u_d_e</code> in a terminal). Check the log at <code>%TEMP%\claude_lcd_daemon.log</code> (Windows) or <code>/tmp/claude_lcd_daemon.log</code> . |
| "Device not functioning" during setup (Windows) | Re-run <code>setup.ps1</code> — it replaces the incompatible CH340 driver with the working v3.4 from the drive.                                                                               |
| Port "busy" or won't open                       | Unplug and re-plug the USB-C cable — the device is found automatically.                                                                                                                       |

## 9. Technical specifications

|               |                                                                                 |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Controller    | Arduino Nano (ATmega328P)                                                       |
| Display       | 20×4 character LCD (HD44780) over I <sup>2</sup> C, 5×8-dot character generator |
| Button        | mechanical, on the right side face of the enclosure                             |
| Sound         | piezo buzzer                                                                    |
| Clock         | synced from the computer automatically                                          |
| Connection    | USB-C (power + data)                                                            |
| Compatibility | Windows 10/11, Linux, macOS 11+                                                 |